returned from Germany were targeted by those who wanted to shave their heads and humiliate them in public for ‘collaborating’ with the Nazi regime.

Most of these women came from modest backgrounds. To protect themselves, they kept their time in Germany a secret, and their stories were lost and not passed down to future generations.

This novel is my attempt to work through the nuance and complexity of the Nazi occupation of France while giving voice to the thousands of young French women who went through the experience of working in Germany during the war.

I learned a lot while researching and writing this story, and I hope you’ve enjoyed reading it. If you did, I’d be grateful if you could take the time to write a review online. Your review can help other readers find my work.

If you’d like to get in touch with me—I love hearing from readers and speaking at book clubs—you can find all my contact details and book club guides for my novels at cynthiaanderson.co.uk. You can also sign up for my newsletter to learn about what I’m reading and to receive a notification when my next book is released.